My instinctive reaction, when I first saw Haseeb Hameed in India in 2016, was, ‘Blimey, this kid can bat.’ I wasn’t alone: Sachin Tendulkar offered him an audience and Virat Kohli predicted he would be a star in all forms of the game. Aged only nineteen, he scored 82 in the first Test at Rajkot and a half-century, batting with a badly broken thumb, in the second Test at Mohali.

Then … he fell off the face of the earth.

Technically, there is a hint of concern against short-pitched bowling. Temperamentally, there is a price to be paid for his obsessional approach, which carries the inherent danger of putting process before outcome. I have no inside knowledge, but sport has many examples of problems created by the emotional intensity of having a father as a coach. It is hard for the parent, too.

It is never nice to look down the wicket and see someone being consumed by their fears and neuroses. I have a lot of time for Nick Compton. Since he was the grandson of Denis Compton, a definitive post-war cricket hero, he bore the burden of the family name well. We played sixteen Tests together, in two spells. He helped us win in India in 2012 and scored a couple of excellent hundreds in New Zealand the following year, but the pressure eventually got to him.

Insecurity is insidious. Nick sought reassurance from too many people, and it worked against him, with his natural intensity. His explosive release of tension after completing his first Test hundred showed how much it meant to him, but you could see the game eating him alive. He took a six-week break after his final series against Sri Lanka, helped Middlesex win the County Championship in unforgettable fashion, and now combines photography with commercial and media activity.

Fitting, that, because cricket is a freeze-frame image of who we are. Why do we do it? Here’s a hint …